

Panda HSK — User Guide

Welcome! **Panda HSK** helps you learn Chinese vocabulary for the **HSK 1–3** exams. Your study buddy is **Bao**, a panda who smiles when you get things right and droops a little when you slip up. This guide walks you through everything the app can do.

Getting started

Open the app in any modern web browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge, or Firefox) on a phone, tablet, or computer. Nothing to install, nothing to sign up for. Your progress is saved automatically on your own device.

At the **top** you'll see Bao, the app name, and a 🐼 counter showing how many words you've studied so far. Just below is the **HSK level bar**. At the **bottom** are the three main sections: **Study**, **Quiz**, and **Browse**.

Choosing your level

The level bar appears on every screen:

Tab	What you get
HSK 1	300 beginner words
HSK 2	200 words
HSK 3	500 words
All	All 1000 words together

Tap a level any time to switch. The app remembers your choice for next time.

1. Study mode (flashcards)

This is where you learn new words at your own pace.

- A card shows one word. **Tap the card** (or press **Flip card**) to turn it over and reveal the character, pinyin, part of speech, and English meaning.
- Use the ◀ / ▶ arrows to move between cards.
- 🔄 **Shuffle** mixes the order so you're not just memorising positions.
- ↺ **Restart** returns to the first card.

Choose what you see first using the three pills above the card:

- **汉字 first** — see the character, recall the meaning (good for reading).
- **拼音 first** — see the pinyin, recall the character and meaning.
- **English first** — see the meaning, recall the Chinese (good for speaking).

Hear the word: after you flip a card, tap the round **speaker** button to hear it pronounced in Mandarin.

The progress bar and the "12 / 300" counter show where you are in the current deck.

2. Quiz mode

Test yourself with ten quick multiple-choice questions.

- Each question shows either a **character** (pick the English meaning) or an **English meaning** (pick the matching character). The mix keeps you sharp in both directions.
- Tap an answer. A correct choice turns **green** and a cheerful 很好! / **NICE!** seal stamps onto the card; a wrong choice turns **red** and the correct answer is highlighted.
- Bao reacts to every answer, and the word is read aloud so you hear it as you go.
- Your **score** and **question number** sit at the top.

At the end you'll see your final score, an encouraging message, and — if you beat your previous result for that level — a 🏆 **New best score!** badge. Tap **Play again** for a fresh set of questions.

Best scores are saved per level, so you can chase a perfect 10 on each one.

3. Browse mode

A searchable dictionary of every word in the current level.

- Type in the **search box** to filter instantly. You can search by:
- **character** (e.g. 茶)
- **pinyin** — with or without tone marks both work (hǎo or hao)
- **English** (e.g. tea)
- Each row shows the character, pinyin, meaning, part of speech, and its HSK level.
- Tap the **speaker** on any row to hear it.

Tips for studying

- **Start small.** Do one level at a time. Shuffle a deck, flip through it, then take a quiz.
- **Switch directions.** Reading practice (汉字 first) and recall practice (English first) build different skills — alternate between them.
- **Quiz often.** Short, frequent quizzes beat long cramming sessions for memory.
- **Use the 本 counter** as a gentle nudge — every new card you open adds to it.

Frequently asked questions

Is my progress saved? Yes — your studied-word count, best quiz scores, and settings are stored in your browser on the device you're using. Using a different device or browser starts fresh.

No sound plays when I tap the speaker. Pronunciation uses your browser's built-in text-to-speech. Most phones and computers include a Mandarin voice. If yours doesn't, you may need to add a Chinese language pack in your device settings; the rest of the app still works without it.

Can I use it offline? Once the page has loaded once, it keeps working without a connection. (The very first load needs internet to fetch the fonts.)

Can more words or levels be added? Yes — see the README for how to add HSK 4 and beyond.

Happy studying! 加油! 🍀